

SHOWCASE

Clarke

Despite its name, Clarke is actually a robot. A recycling robot at that. Clarke was developed by AMP Robotics, who also gave it its name. Clarke uses artificial intelligence to recognise and sort food and beverage containers. Meaning, if you were to use Clarke at a landfill, or the local dumping grounds if you will, Clarke will be able to pick out



and separate the milk and juice cartons, the food packaging and other such containers, which you will then be able to send to the appropriate recycling facility.

Clarke has already been deployed at a municipal waste facility in Denver Colorado,

where it has shown a reliable rate of going through 60 items in a minute and has an accuracy of 90 percent when it comes to picking up recyclable waste. That's much faster than any human (up to 50 percent faster) could do the same job.

The best part is that Clarke functions on an AI-based system. This means that the more it works, the smarter it gets. While right now it may only know sorting by materials, i.e., cardboard, plastic, carton etc, over time it could learn to distinguish between individual items it's sorting, i.e., soft drink bottles, soymilk cartons, pizza packaging etc.

This is a big step forward in terms of recycling tech.

Xbox Controller Wireless Adapter

If you've ever used a wireless Xbox Controller with your PC, then you're probably aware of how bulky the adapter was.

Well, good news! Microsoft has toned down the size of the adapter so it's about the size of a regular USB flash drive now. If you're looking for a number to put on the down-scaling, it's 66 percent smaller than the previous bulky black slab. The new adapter started shipping early in August for \$24.99 and it can connect to up to eight Xbox controllers at once. We don't know of any occasions



where you'll need to have eight Xbox controllers attached to your PC but it's good to know that you have the option to do so regardless.

The new adapter comes with a little cap and an indicator light which lets you know when you're good to pair and once you're connected. If you've got a headset plugged into your controller, the adapter can even beam the sound to your controller wirelessly.

Sony had recently released their own wireless adapter for PC for their PS4 DualShock controllers and at the time their adapter definitely had a one-up over Microsoft. Well, Xbox is back in the game now.

Garner Holt Productions' Lincoln Robot

Garner Holt Productions have built many animatronic figures in the past, most of which are located in prominent theme parks. Even Disney thinks they're good enough to head their audio-animatronics at Disney World. Their most recent endeavour is an Abraham Lincoln robot, and this one's insanely realistic.

The robot is capable of 40 unique motions and is built using proprietary silicon skin. Along with the realism of the skin and its ability to almost flawlessly replicate complex wrinkles of human skin, the Lincoln robot has amazing facial expressions, dare we say, the best we've seen on a robot yet.



The robot is just a bust of Lincoln and was first showcased at Disney's D23 fan club extravaganza which was held in July. While this was just a demonstration at that time, it's planned to be part of a series which will go by the name "The Living Faces of History". The series will be offered to theme park clients and museums who would be interested in realistic animatronic displays of historically significant figures.

The Shaman character from Disney's World of Avatar attraction is touted to be Garner Holt Productions' best animatronic so far, but it looks like it won't keep that throne for long, with none other than Abraham Lincoln in the run for the title.